

Margot Ledger

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling demanded that you disguise several gala and naming-wing expenses inside restricted museum funds until his promised donation cleared. When you resisted, he threatened to blame the bookkeeping on you.

What you are hiding

You temporarily moved money between internal accounts to cover a cash-flow shortfall, intending to reverse it after the gala. It was technically unauthorized and Sterling discovered it. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Find out whether Helena has seen Sterling's draft funding agreement.
- Keep Adrian from learning about the temporary transfer unless absolutely necessary.
- Identify who found the donor ledger during the scavenger hunt.

What you know about other guests

- Adrian's future at the museum is threatened by Sterling's proposed governance agreement.
- Maya's education program would lose funding under one version of Sterling's gift conditions.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

You met Sterling at 6:33 for a signature. From 6:40 to 6:50, the finance terminal audit shows you reversing and re-entering the unauthorized internal transfer you were trying to hide. That audit trail clears your timing but exposes the accounting violation.

IF MURDERER

At 6:46 you returned to obtain the signature Sterling had withheld. When he mocked the accounting mess he had helped create, you poisoned his cordial. You then copied a budget sheet to create the impression your office visit happened earlier.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card B. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card A. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I moved restricted funds without authorization. I intended to put every dollar back, and Sterling planned to make me the villain. The finance terminal audit shows me correcting that transfer throughout the poisoning window. That secret is ugly enough. It is not murder.

IF MURDERER

Sterling created the problem, ordered me to hide it, and then prepared to sacrifice me for it. When he refused the signature that would have protected the museum, I poisoned his drink. Then I used the copier clock to manufacture an earlier paper trail. I have spent my career making numbers reconcile. Tonight I made a life disappear instead.